Week 3 Assignment: Jargon-to-Plain-English Clinic

Name:
G Sahasra (2620090001)

Passage 1: Rewrite

Right now, fixing the client's login bug before Friday is our main focus. The bug is holding up three other tasks, so we need to handle it straight away. The client is unhappy, so we must use all of our team's available time this week. We have already tried two quick fixes, and neither worked. Tomorrow morning, the whole team will meet briefly and agree on a plan for the next steps. This ought to be an easy fix, yet we keep running into new problems. After we identify the root cause, we intend to study the server logs in depth together. Then we will get back to the client and begin work on the next update immediately. Please write back to me with your progress by 5 p.m. today. If we stay on one plan and act quickly, we can close this ticket by tomorrow.

Shortly, we plan to fix two more small bugs in the same module. The second one looks like an easy fix, so it should be quick. We still do not know why the server crashes every night. The new intern offered to handle this bug while the senior developer is away on leave. Tomorrow morning, a different engineer will sign in to the system to check the crash logs. We hope these small fixes will make a real dent in the number of daily crashes. The client has asked for useful explanations of why this keeps happening. We want to improve the whole server system, not merely patch one small part. This extra work will also give the client an extra benefit, since it may prevent future problems. We should complete it promptly and keep everyone informed.

Late last night, the team finally discovered the real cause of the crash. We are currently writing a permanent fix rather than another quick patch. Usually, we test every fix twice before it goes to the client. Since this bug affected several clients, we will test even more carefully this time. We will keep running on the new server for one full day before calling it stable. After that, the team will proceed with deployment to all remaining clients. This fix covers all of our core deliverables for this sprint, not only the login page. Our manager called it a full solution and a big step forward for the support team. The new system can grow with demand and sits on a sturdier framework than the old one. This fix should improve our whole product, and the team is ready to begin the next project immediately.

Passage 1: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at this point in time / at this juncture	right now / still	wordy phrase
creating a bottleneck for	holding up	cliché
look after this issue	handle it	wrong phrasal verb ("look after" means care for)
due to the fact that / on account of the fact that	since	wordy phrase
leverage our full team bandwidth	use all of our team's available time	jargon
it is important to note that / it should be noted that	(removed)	filler
touch base and get on the same page	meet briefly and agree on a plan	cliché
for all intents and purposes	(removed)	filler
deep dive into	study in depth	jargon
circle back with	get back to	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
hit the ground running	begin immediately	cliché
revert back to me	write back to me	misused ("revert" means return to a previous state) and redundant
in the near future	shortly	wordy phrase
low-hanging fruit	easy fix	cliché
take after this bug	handle this bug	wrong phrasal verb ("take after" means resemble)
enter into the system	sign in to the system	wrong phrasal verb
move the needle	make a real dent in	cliché
with reference to the above	(removed)	filler
actionable insights	useful explanations	jargon
optimize the whole server ecosystem	improve the whole server system	jargon
value-add	extra benefit	jargon
in a timely manner	promptly	wordy phrase
in the process of writing	currently writing	wordy phrase
as a general rule	usually	wordy phrase
put up with	keep running on	wrong phrasal verb ("put up with" means tolerate)
continue on with	proceed with	redundant
end-to-end solution	full solution	jargon
game-changer	big step forward	cliché
scalable / robust	can grow with demand / sturdier	jargon
take to the next-level	improve	cliché

Passage 2: Rewrite

Today, our team held its yearly planning meeting to discuss this year's plan. Our main goal is to cooperate more closely with the marketing department. Since the last product launch was slow, we must improve on that this time. We agreed on five new action items and shared them with everyone with a stake in the plan. About hiring, we should consult the HR team before posting any new job. Everyone agreed to be creative and try a few new marketing ideas this quarter. However, we should not stake everything on one idea by spending our entire budget on it. Next, the design team will look closely at customer feedback and our main strengths. We should cut our travel costs so we can spend more on this project. If everyone stays creative and stops staking everything on one idea, this plan can succeed.

Afterwards, the whole team met again to review our new marketing roadmap. At that time, everyone agreed that we needed a learning-focused mindset. Our manager called this a small shift in thinking for the whole marketing team. Let's go through the budget numbers together before we plan the next campaign. From here on, we also want more agreement and backing from the sales department. A mixed-department team will work faster than one department alone. We should increase our social media budget a little to support the new plan. Everyone agreed on one guiding goal for this quarter: more repeat customers. The whole team is trying to be creative while planning these new campaigns.

Regarding sales, the new plan already looks promising after just two weeks. We have already found one early success: a simple change to our email subject lines. In the end, the value we offer customers needed to be clearer than before. Since our old website was slow, we lost several new customers last month. The design team studied a few proven methods from other companies in our field. Sadly, two members chose to leave the project team this month. Mostly, the client understood why we had to delay the product launch by two weeks. Our head of marketing now wants more expert opinion pieces on our blog and social pages. Talking to real customers helped us understand their frustrations and expand into new cities. This project taught us again not to stake everything on one idea.

Passage 2: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at the present moment in time / at that particular point in time	today / then	wordy phrase
annual alignment meeting	yearly planning meeting	vague jargon
needless to say / it goes without saying	(removed)	filler
synergize better with	cooperate more closely with	jargon
in light of the fact that / by virtue of the fact that	since / because	wordy phrase
take it to the next level	improve on that	cliché
key stakeholders	everyone with a stake in the plan	jargon
with regard to the matter of	about	wordy phrase
look up to the HR team	consult the HR team	wrong phrasal verb ("look up to" means admire)
think outside the box	be creative	cliché
put all our eggs in one basket	stake everything on one idea	cliché
drill down into	look closely at	jargon
core competencies	main strengths	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
lower down / raise up	cut / increase	redundant
in due course	afterwards	wordy phrase
growth mindset	learning-focused mindset	jargon
paradigm shift	small shift in thinking	jargon
get over the budget numbers	go through the budget numbers	wrong phrasal verb ("get over" means recover from)
on a going-forward basis	from here on	wordy phrase
buy-in	agreement and backing	jargon
cross-functional team	mixed-department team	jargon
north star	guiding goal	cliché
as far as sales are concerned	regarding sales	wordy phrase
quick win	early success	jargon
in the final analysis / for the most part	in the end / mostly	wordy phrase
value proposition	the value we offer customers	jargon
best practices	proven methods	jargon
exit out of	leave	redundant
call on the product launch	delay the product launch	wrong phrasal verb ("call on" means visit or ask)
thought leadership content	expert opinion pieces	jargon
pain points	frustrations	jargon
grow our footprint	expand into	cliché

Passage 3: Rewrite

Your report shows good effort, but a few sections still need work. If you have time before Friday, please add more practical recommendations for the sales team. To be clear, please explain your data in finer detail in section three. As I said, the client wants us to make the entire onboarding process simpler. Please recheck these figures, since two of the numbers do not match the original file. We also expect extra value in your final recommendations, not only a summary of the data. Try a wider approach and think about every contact point with customers, not just the sales numbers. Our team routinely reviews these reports together before sending them to the client. Please send the corrected file back to me by Monday morning. It's up to you now, and this report reflects your own hard work. Let's talk about it again tomorrow.

Please send the revised report when you can, ideally before Wednesday. To be sure the numbers are correct, please check them one more time. Could you reread the introduction once more before you send it back to me? In the third section, try to compare our results against a clear reference point. Since this report will go to senior management, please keep the key takeaways short and clear. An evidence-based approach in section two will also strengthen your argument. Try to give your final chart a more professional, top-quality look. Please merge the two small tables into one, since they show similar numbers. Make your suggestions more practical so the team knows exactly what to do next. A few small changes will refine your report and make it much stronger.

Your revised report is much clearer than the first draft. Generally, small changes like these make a big difference to the reader. Please recheck the conclusion and read the last two sentences carefully. Your new chart is far more striking than the old one. Your writing also feels more reader-focused now, since you explain things from the client's point of view. All in all, this report shows that you can improve quickly based on feedback. Please total up all the final numbers before you send this to the client. Your recommendations are now more centered on value and results than before. This report also shows a clearer strategic direction for the whole project. It's up to you one last time, so please send the final file by tomorrow.

Passage 3: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at the end of the day	(removed)	cliché filler
in the event that	if	wordy phrase
actionable feedback / actionable	practical recommendations / practical	jargon
for the purpose of clarity	to be clear	wordy phrase
more granular level	finer detail	jargon
as previously mentioned above	as I said	redundant
streamline	make simpler	jargon
check up these figures	recheck these figures	wrong phrasal verb ("check up" needs "on")
value addition	extra value	jargon
holistic approach	wider approach	jargon
customer touchpoints	every contact point with customers	jargon
on a regular basis	routinely	wordy phrase
return back	send back	redundant
the ball is in your court	it's up to you now	cliché

Original	Plain English	Why
at your earliest convenience	when you can	wordy phrase
in order to ensure	to be sure	wordy phrase
go off the introduction	reread the introduction	wrong phrasal verb ("go off" means explode or leave)
with respect to	in	wordy phrase
owing to the fact that	since	wordy phrase
benchmark	reference point	jargon
data-driven approach	evidence-based approach	jargon
best-in-class	top-quality	jargon
combine together	merge	redundant
as things currently stand	(removed)	wordy phrase
in the majority of cases	generally	wordy phrase
look for the conclusion	recheck the conclusion	wrong phrasal verb ("look for" means search for)
it is worth mentioning that	(removed)	filler
impactful	far more striking	vague jargon
user-centric	reader-focused	jargon
on the whole	all in all	wordy phrase
iterate	improve	jargon
add up together	total up	redundant
value-driven and results-oriented	centered on value and results	jargon

Passage 4: Rewrite

India's AI conversation has largely centred on big enterprises and giant cloud providers running large language models (LLMs) on systems built in the cloud. Yet a much bigger opportunity lies in the country's over 60 million small and medium businesses (SMBs). Together, these firms contribute nearly a third of India's GDP and make up the backbone of the economy. Despite this scale, AI adoption among SMBs remains limited, held back by disconnected IT systems, a limited ability to link software systems through APIs (standard ways for programs to exchange data), and the belief that advanced AI is reserved for organisations with deep pockets and dedicated data science teams.

Tata Communications and Tata Tele-Business Services (TTBS) now aim to close this gap. Rather than launching yet another stand-alone application, the two companies describe their collaboration as one platform serving many businesses at once. It runs on growable cloud computing and edge connectivity (networks and computing close to the user), and it is meant to make enterprise-grade AI infrastructure more affordable and accessible for smaller firms so they can grow efficiently.

For many SMBs, the difficulty has never been recognising AI's potential. It has been managing the rollout, since businesses often have to work with several vendors for network connections, cloud infrastructure, data-sovereignty compliance and customer engagement tools. Integration costs, slow response times and the need for specialised technical skills often outweigh the perceived benefits, which slows adoption.

The first result of the partnership is an AI-powered Voice Agent platform, hosted on a dedicated AI cloud and driven by the companies' own conversational AI engine. Businesses can use it to deploy agents that understand natural language and can handle enquiries, appointment scheduling and orders easily. Unlike older interactive voice response (IVR) menu systems, these agents turn speech into text and text back into speech to talk naturally with customers, and they work around the clock without any human involvement.

Ultimately, executives frame the partnership as a rare and major shift, arguing that access to robust network infrastructure and very fast computing power may soon matter as much as access to the AI models themselves. Whether this vision becomes reality will depend on execution, affordability, and how quickly SMBs grow comfortable trusting new digital technology.

Passage 4: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
for the most part	largely	wordy phrase
hyperscalers	giant cloud providers	jargon
cloud-native infrastructure	systems built in the cloud	jargon
bigger and greater / more than over	much bigger / over	redundant
lie / contributes / comprises	lies / contribute / make up	grammar and word choice ("comprises" is misused here)
fragmented IT infrastructure	disconnected IT systems	jargon
API integration capabilities	ability to link software systems through APIs (standard ways for programs to exchange data)	jargon, explained
looking forward to close	aim to close	wrong phrasal verb and grammar
multi-tenant	one platform serving many businesses at once	technical jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
scalable, edge connectivity	growable cloud computing and edge connectivity (networks and computing close to the user)	jargon
to grow and to scale efficiently and effectively	grow efficiently	redundant
conundrum	difficulty	unnecessary formal word
recognising and identifying	recognising	redundant
deployment orchestration	managing the rollout	jargon
traverse multiple different vendors	work with several vendors	wordy
connectivity provisioning	network connections	jargon
latency issues	slow response times	jargon
really specialised / almost frequently	specialised / often	redundant, wrong adverb
outcome and result	result	redundant
proprietary conversational AI engine	their own conversational AI engine	jargon
capable of and able to handle	can handle	redundant
with relative ease and without much difficulty	easily	redundant
leverage speech-to-text and text-to-speech pipelines and processes	turn speech into text and text back into speech	jargon, redundant
around the clock, 24 hours a day / without human intervention whatsoever	around the clock / without any human involvement	redundant
in the end	ultimately	wordy phrase
game-changer that happens once in a blue moon	rare and major shift	mixed clichés
low-latency compute / model architectures	very fast computing power / AI models	jargon
materialises off	becomes reality	wrong phrasal verb
putting their trust up into	trusting	wrong phrasal verb
digital transformation technology	new digital technology	jargon

Passage 5: Rewrite

A Chinese startup called Linkerbot is developing a solution to one of robotics' toughest problems: dexterous robotic hands with many separately moving joints. Founded in 2023 by CEO Alex Zhou, the Beijing-based firm makes five-fingered robotic hands with touch sensors and motors that allow humanoid robots to grasp objects, tighten screws and, eventually, handle household chores like cooking and cleaning.

Recreating the human hand, with its fine control, adaptable grip strength and sensory feedback, is an enormous challenge, industry insiders say. Even Tesla's Optimus struggles with hand dexterity, even though its legs work well. Zhou thinks that pairing artificial intelligence with China's manufacturing strength will close this technology gap for good.

Linkerbot has raised a great deal of money, closing a Series B+ funding round in April that valued it at $3 billion, a staggering sum for such a young company. Zhou is now pursuing a $6 billion valuation, which would make him a billionaire almost overnight, and investors are lining up to join in.

The company's competitive edge is low cost, because Linkerbot makes almost all of its components in-house. From motor assembly to sensor calibration, it can undercut rivals such as Singapore's Sharpa and London's Shadow Robot by a wide margin. Zhou insists that economies of scale will bring the hardware cost down to under $100 per pair within three years, a price that would greatly undercut rivals.

Analysts warn, however, that the robotic-hands sector could slide into a race to the bottom, known in China as "involution", as competitors slash prices to stay in business. Some fear the industry could overreach, mass-producing hands faster than the underlying AI and motor technology can keep pace. Whether Linkerbot can stay afloat while scaling to 100,000 units a year and improving how many separate joint movements its hands can manage remains to be seen.

Passage 5: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
are cooking up a solution	is developing a solution	cliché and grammar
biggest headaches	toughest problems	cliché
multi-degree-of-freedom	with many separately moving joints	jargon
actuator motors	motors	jargon
reverse-engineering	recreating	jargon
herculean task	enormous challenge	cliché
reckons	thinks	informal
manufacturing muscle	manufacturing strength	cliché
once and for all	for good	cliché
massive amounts of capital	a great deal of money	jargon
eye-watering sum	staggering sum	cliché
overnight, so to speak	almost overnight	filler
lining out to put in on the action	lining up to join in	wrong phrasal verbs
competitive hedge, redundantly speaking	competitive edge	wrong word ("hedge" means protection) and filler
nearly almost all	almost all	redundant
vertically integrates ... in-house	makes ... in-house	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
bring downwards ... down	bring down	redundant
bill of materials	hardware cost	jargon
benchmark / undercut off	price / undercut	jargon, wrong phrasal verb
race to the bottom	kept, explained	idiom, clarified
stay put in the game	stay in business	wrong phrasal verb and cliché
biting off more than it can swallow	overreach	garbled idiom
keep on up with	keep pace with	wrong phrasal verb
keep its head above the water	stay afloat	garbled idiom
degrees-of-freedom benchmarks	how many separate joint movements its hands can manage	jargon
remains to be saw	remains to be seen	grammar